

Ibrahim Said Ahmad, PhD

Assistant Professor · University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point

2100 Main St, Stevens Point, WI 54481, USA · (857)-397-3275 · ibrahimsaidahmad@outlook.com · [isahmadbbr.github.io](https://github.com/isahmadbbr) · linkedin.com/in/isahmadbbr

U.S. Permanent Resident (Green Card) — No sponsorship required

Summary

A Computer Scientist and NLP Researcher, specializing in Natural Language Processing, Data Science, and AI for Social Good. Award-winning researcher and collaborative leader with 10+ years of experience in teaching, research, and interdisciplinary collaboration, specializing in NLP for low-resource languages — including emotion analysis, hate speech detection, and sentiment analysis across 18+ African languages — as well as cross-cultural and multicultural AI research. As co-founder of Arewa Data Science and HausaNLP, I am committed to democratizing data science and machine learning education across Africa. I have led large-scale, cross-continental initiatives (e.g., AfriSenti, AfriHate, BRIGHTER, POLAR) spanning Africa, Asia, Europe, and the Americas, secured over \$800,000 in competitive grant funding, and published 40+ peer-reviewed papers, several recognized with best paper and best resource paper awards. I am currently an Assistant Professor at the University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point, continuing this work through teaching, mentoring, and research in emotion-aware, culturally-informed AI.

Education

PhD, Computer Science

2016 — 2020

Malaysia

Universiti Kebangsaan Malaysia

Dissertation: *Purchase Intention Mining Approach for Movie Revenue Prediction.*

MSc, Information Technology

2013 — 2015

Malaysia

The University of Nottingham

Dissertation: *Engaging Children with ADHD using Mobile Games.*

BSc, Computer Science

2006 — 2012

Nigeria

Bayero University Kano

Work Experience

Assistant Professor, Department of Computing and New Media Technologies

Aug. 25, 2025 — Present

United States

University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point

2100 Main St, Stevens Point, WI 54481, USA

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute for Experiential AI

Jul. 5, 2023 — Jul. 4, 2025

United States

Northeastern University

100 Fore Street, Portland, ME 04101, USA.

Senior Lecturer (U.S. equiv.: Assistant Professor)

2020 — 2023

Nigeria

Bayero University Kano

Faculty of Computing, BUK Newsite, Gwarzo Road, Kano 700241, Nigeria.

Assistant Lecturer

2014 — 2016

Nigeria

Bayero University Kano

Faculty of Computing, BUK Newsite, Gwarzo Road, Kano 700241, Nigeria.

Promoted to Lecturer II in 2017 while on PhD study fellowship.

Research Interests

- Natural Language Processing and Computational Social Science.
- Cross-cultural collaborative research in NLP.
- Ethical AI and bias mitigation in multilingual NLP.
- Predictive Modeling for Business Applications.
- Democratization of data science and machine learning.

Teaching

University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point

Fundamentals of Artificial Intelligence	Undergraduate	2025 – Date
Introduction to Computing and Programming	Undergraduate	2025 – Date
Programming for AI and ML	Undergraduate	2026 – Date
Neural Network and Deep Learning	Undergraduate	2026 – Date

Bayero University Kano

Artificial Intelligence	Graduate	2022 & 2023
Database Systems	Undergraduate	2021 & 2022
Introduction to Probability	Undergraduate	2015
Multimedia Techniques	Undergraduate	2015

Research Experience

Open Data Collection Playbook & Platform (Waraka)

Co-PI, Masakhane African Languages Hub Grant (\$430,000) 2025 – Present

- Co-leading a 15-month project to build WARAKA, an open community handbook and companion annotation platform for collecting, annotating, and releasing text, speech, and vision datasets for African languages, in partnership with Masakhane, EthioNLP, and HausaNLP.
- Directed project planning and design: stakeholder and user-needs assessments, co-design workshops, and a gap analysis of existing annotation playbooks to define the platform's modular structure and multilingual, offline, and low-literacy accessibility requirements.
- Overseeing development of the platform (`annotate.waraka.ai`) and playbook (`playbook.waraka.ai`), including annotation workflows, multimedia and print-ready resources, contribution/version-control processes, and a GDPR-compliant privacy review.
- Leading testing, public deployment, and community-governance planning, including usability evaluation, maintainer documentation, and a final impact assessment.

POLAR: Multilingual, Multicultural, and Multi-Event Online Polarization Detection

Assistant Professor, University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point 2025 – 2026

- Co-developed POLAR, a benchmark of 23,000+ instances spanning 22 typologically diverse languages for detecting political, racial, religious, and gender-based polarization in online text.
- Co-organized SemEval-2026 Task 9: Detecting Multilingual, Multicultural and Multievent Online Polarization, a shared task built on the benchmark.

Modeling Annotator Disagreement in Subjective NLP Tasks

Assistant Professor, University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point 2025 – 2026

- Contributed to an agreement-based clustering approach for modeling annotator perspectives (rather than collapsing disagreement via majority vote) across 40 datasets in 18 typologically diverse languages.
- Evaluated the approach on three subjective NLP tasks – sentiment analysis, emotion classification, and hate speech detection – published in *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics* (2026).

Going PLACES: Participatory Localized Red Teaming for Text-to-Image Safety in the Global South

2024 – 2026

Assistant Professor, University of Wisconsin-Stevens Point

- Contributed to a community-centered red-teaming study of text-to-image model safety in secondary urban centers across Ghana, Nigeria, and two regions of India, in partnership with local universities.
- Helped produce PLACES, a dataset of 26,000+ examples of text-to-image model failures, revealing socio-cultural and linguistic gaps in existing geography-agnostic safety datasets; published at the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT 2026).

Bridging the Gap in Text-Based Emotion Detection

Sep. 2023 – 2025

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Northeastern University

- Co-developed BRIGHTER, a large, high-quality human-annotated emotion dataset for 28 languages (18 African), supporting emotion detection, intensity classification, and cross-lingual emotion analysis; published at ACL 2025 and awarded the **Best Resource Paper Award**.
- Conducting monolingual and multi-lingual experiments on multi-label emotion detection, emotion intensity classification and cross-lingual emotion detection.
- Organized SemEval 2025 Task 11: Bridging the Gap in Text-Based Emotion Detection, built on BRIGHTER, which received the **Best Task Paper Award**.

Cultural Representations of Emotions in LLMs through Mixed Emotion Survey

Sep. 2023 – 2025

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Northeastern University

- Designed and conducted experiments studying emotion representations of Western and East Asian cultures by surveying five LLMs (Mistral, Gemma, Llama, GPT-3.5, GPT-4) on mixed-emotion situations, comparing outputs against a prior human study on Japanese and American mixed-emotion experience.
- Found that all five LLMs demonstrate limited alignment with the mixed-emotion phenomena documented in the human study; published at ACII 2024 and awarded the conference's **Best Paper Award**.

Exploring Cross-Cultural Alignment in LLMs Responses

Sep. 2023 – June 2024

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Northeastern University

- Designed and conducted experiments investigating the cultural and emotional alignment of ChatGPT responses with those of native Hausa speakers, using 37 culturally relevant prompts validated by a psycholinguistic expert in Hausa language and culture.
- Assessed alignment via human ratings, sentiment analysis, and textual similarity (BERTScore, METEOR) between ChatGPT and human responses; published as "Are Generative Language Models Multicultural? A Study on Hausa Culture and Emotions using ChatGPT" at the 2nd Workshop on Cross-Cultural Considerations in NLP (C3NLP), ACL 2024.

AfriHate: A Multilingual Hate and Offensive Corpus for Africa

Sep. 2023 – 2024

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Northeastern University

- Developed AFRIHATE, the first labelled dataset for hate in 18 African languages from 6 countries.
- Benchmarked baseline models (using SOTA pre-trained LLMs) for each language.
- Investigating various cultural, linguistic, and technical challenges of working across so many diverse and low-resource languages on an inherently subjective concept of hate.

A Benchmark of WikiArt with Captions in 28 Languages

Jul. 2023 – 2025

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Northeastern University

- Collected 200K emotion labels and affective textual explanations in 25 languages on 2000 images (with ~140 annotations per image).
- Proposed a benchmark to evaluate the Zero-Shot, Few-Shot, and One-vs-All Zero-Shot performance of Multimodal models.

- Adapted and benchmarked four contemporary Vision and Language models to work on our multilingual setup.
- Studied pairwise language transfer revealing insights on cultural differences in emotional perception and expression.

Analyzing COVID-19 Vaccination Sentiments in Nigerian Cyberspace

Aug. 2021 – Dec. 2022

Senior Lecturer, Bayero University Kano

- Built and manually annotated a Twitter dataset on COVID-19 vaccination sentiment in Nigerian cyberspace, and benchmarked classical ML (SVM, Logistic Regression) and fine-tuned LLMs (BERT, Afro-XLM-R, XLM-RoBERTa) for sentiment classification.

A Nigerian Twitter Sentiment Corpus for Multilingual Sentiment Analysis

December 2020 – July 2022

Senior Lecturer, Bayero University Kano

- Developed the first large-scale, manually annotated Twitter sentiment dataset and lexicon for the four main Nigerian languages, with benchmark experiments using pre-trained language models and transfer learning.

Purchase Intention Mining Approach with Novel Features From Social Media for Movie Revenue Prediction

March 2016 – April 2020

Doctoral Researcher, Universiti Kebangsaan Malaysia

- Developed a box-office revenue prediction corpus and purchase intention lexicon (PIL) from movie trailer reviews (YouTube, Box Office Mojo), and proposed the MRPI approach, evaluated against MLR, SVM, MLP, and RF models. (PhD dissertation research.)

Skills

Technical Proficiencies

- **Natural Language Processing (NLP):** Low-resource language processing, sentiment analysis, hate speech detection, emotion analysis.
- **Machine Learning:** Deep learning, transfer learning, predictive modeling.
- **Large Language Models:** Development, fine-tuning, and adaptation for low-resource languages.
- **Programming:** Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib.
- **Data Science:** Statistical analysis, data visualization, feature engineering.
- **Tools:** Git, Google Cloud, Jupyter Notebooks, Hugging Face Transformers.

Languages

- Fluent: English, Hausa.
- Working proficiency: Malay, Arabic.
- Linguistic analysis expertise in English and 20 low-resource languages.

Research and Academic

- Experimental design and implementation.
- Academic writing and publication.
- Grant writing and management.
- Cross-cultural collaborative research.

Ethical AI and Responsible Development

- Bias detection and mitigation in multilingual NLP.
- Ethical framework development for AI applications.
- Fairness and accountability in machine learning models.

Project Management and Leadership

- Team leadership and mentoring.

- Cross-cultural communication and collaboration.

Grants & Honors

Grants

2025	CO-PI , Masakhane African Languages Hub – Open Data Collection Playbook & Platform	\$430,000
2023	PI , Google Research exploreCSR award	\$18,000
2023	PI , Google Research TensorFlow award	\$10,000
2022	CO-PI , Artificial Intelligence for Education Innovation Research Network in Africa	\$40,000
2022	CO-PI , Oracle OCI Award	\$50,000
2022	CO-PI , Lacuna Fund for Labeled datasets for Language for Sub-Saharan Africa	\$107,895.84
2022	PI , Google Research exploreCSR award	\$18,000
2022	PI , TensorFlow award	\$10,000
2021	CO-PI , Lacuna Fund Grant for SemEval Shared Task	\$8,500
2020	CO-PI , Lacuna Fund for Labeled datasets for Language for Sub-Saharan Africa	\$60,923.00
2020	CO-PI , Google Covid-19 Research Grant	\$1,500.00
2020	CO-PI , TETFUND NRF Research Grant	\$50,000.00

Honors

2026	Best Paper Award , POLAR: Detecting Multilingual, Multicultural and Multievent Online Polarization – 9th Workshop on Event Extraction and Understanding, ACL 2026
2026	Best Paper Runner-Up Award , POLAR SemEval Shared Task – SemEval 2026
2025	Best Resource Paper Award , BRIGHTER: BRIDging the Gap in Human-Annotated Textual Emotion Recognition Datasets for 28 Languages – ACL 2025
2025	Best Task Paper Award , SemEval 2025 Task 11: Bridging the Gap in Text-Based Emotion Detection
2024	Best Paper Award , Analyzing Cultural Representations of Emotions in LLMs Through Mixed Emotion Survey – 2024 12th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII)
2024	Best paper honorable mention , SemEval 2024 for organizers of an individual shared task
2023	Best Paper Award , AfricaNLP workshop 2023, Kigali Rwanda
2023	International list of AI solutions for reaching the 17 SGD , IRCAI, Global Top 100 list 2022

Supervision

2022–2023	Boryanka Todorova Mashi , An Improved LightGBM Algorithm Using Bayesian Optimization for Prediction of Vulnerability Exploitation	MS Computer Science
2022–2023	Amina Yusuf Umar , Fake News Detection Based on a Hybrid CNN-GRU Deep Learning Model	MS Computer Science
2023–2024	Khadija Halliru Muhammad , Predicting Individuals' Awareness Towards COVID-19 Precautionary Measures Using Hausa Tweets	MS Computer Science
2024–2025	Abdulkadir Shehu Bichi , Lexical-Sentiment Based Model for Detection of Fake News	MS Computer Science

2024–2025	Aisha Mustapha Ahmad , Transformer-Based Purchase Intention Mining: A Comparative Study Using a Novel Dataset	MS Computer Science
2024–2025	Nur Bala Rabi , Extractive Text Summarization Model for a Low Resource Language	MS Computer Science
2024–2025	Fa'iz Ibrahim Jibia , Prediction of Unemployment Rates with Hybrid Time Series and Machine Learning Techniques in Nigeria	MS Computer Science

Selected Publications

40+ peer-reviewed publications, among them 10+ first author papers. [Google Scholar](#).

- Tadesse Destaw Belay, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Idris Abdulmumin, Abinew Ali Ayele, Alexander Gelbukh, Eusebio Ricárdez-Vázquez, Olga Kolesnikova, Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, and Seid Muhie Yimam. "Beyond Majority Voting: Agreement-Based Clustering to Model Annotator Perspectives in Subjective NLP Tasks." *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics* 14 (2026): 1329–1347.
- Charvi Rastogi, Mukul Bhutani, Minsuk Kahng, Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, Evgeniia Razumovskaia, Priyanka Suresh, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Charu Kalia, Yaaseen Mahomed, Madhurima Maji, Minjae Lee, Alicia Parrish, Jessica Quaye, Vijay Janapa Reddi, Aishwarya Verma, and Lora Aroyo. "Going PLACES: Participatory Localized Red Teaming for Text-to-Image Safety in the Global South." In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '26)*, pages 2608–2642. Association for Computing Machinery (2026).
- Usman Naseem, Robert Geislinger, Juan Ren, Sarah Kohail, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, et al. "POLAR: A Benchmark for Multilingual, Multicultural, and Multi-Event Online Polarization." In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*, pages 28699–28720. Association for Computational Linguistics (2026).
- Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, Nedjma Ousidhoum, Idris Abdulmumin, Jan Philip Wahle, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, et al. "BRIGHTER: BRIdging the Gap in Human-Annotated Textual Emotion Recognition Datasets for 28 Languages." In *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 8895–8916. Association for Computational Linguistics (2025).
- Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Shiran Dudy, Resmi Ramachandranpillai, and Kenneth Church. "Are generative language models multicultural? A study on Hausa culture and emotions using ChatGPT." In Vinodkumar Prabhakaran, Sunipa Dev, Luciana Benotti, Daniel Hershcovich, Laura Cabello, Yong Cao, Ife Adebara, and Li Zhou, editors, *Proceedings of the 2nd Workshop on Cross-Cultural Considerations in NLP*, pages 98–106, Bangkok, Thailand. Association for Computational Linguistics (2024).
- Youssef Mohamed, Runjia Li, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Kilichbek Haydarov, Philip Torr, Kenneth Church, and Mohamed Elhoseiny. "No Culture Left Behind: ArtELingo-28, a Benchmark of WikiArt with Captions in 28 Languages." In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 20939–20962, Miami, Florida, USA. Association for Computational Linguistics (2024).
- Shiran Dudy, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Ryoko Kitajima, and Agata Lapedriza. "Analyzing Cultural Representations of Emotions in LLMs Through Mixed Emotion Survey." In *2024 12th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII)*, pages 346–354. IEEE (2024). **Best Paper Award**.
- Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Lukman Jibril Aliyu, Abubakar Auwal Khalid, Saminu Muhammad Aliyu, Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, Idris Abdulmumin, Bala Mairiga Abduljalil, Bello Shehu Bello, and Amina Imam Abubakar. "Analyzing COVID-19 Vaccination Sentiments in Nigerian Cyberspace: Insights from a Manually Annotated Twitter Dataset." arXiv preprint arXiv:2401.13133 (2024).
- Ismail Abdulrashid, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Aminu Musa, and Mohammed Khalafalla. "Impact of social media posts' characteristics on movie performance prior to release: an explainable machine learning approach." *Electronic Commerce Research* (2024).
- Francielle Vargas, Samuel Guimarães, Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, Diego Alves, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Idris Abdulmumin, Diallo Mohamed, Thiago Pardo, and Fabrício Benevenuto. "HausaHate: An Expert Annotated Corpus for Hausa Hate Speech Detection." In *Proceedings of the 8th Workshop on Online Abuse and Harms (WOAH 2024)*, pages 52–58 (2024).
- Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, David Ifeoluwa Adelani, Sebastian Ruder, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, et al. "NaijaSenti: A Nigerian Twitter Sentiment Corpus for Multilingual Sentiment Analysis." In *Proceedings of the Thir-*

teenth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference, pages 590–602, Marseille, France. European Language Resources Association (2022).

- **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Azuraliza Abu Bakar, and Mohd Ridzwan Yaakub. "Movie revenue prediction based on purchase intention mining using YouTube trailer reviews." *Information Processing & Management* 57, no. 5 (2020): 102278.
- **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Azuraliza Abu Bakar, Mohd Ridzwan Yaakub, and Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad. "A survey on machine learning techniques in movie revenue prediction." *SN Computer Science* 1, no. 4 (2020): 235.
- **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Azuraliza Abu Bakar, Mohd Ridzwan Yaakub, and Mohammad Darwich. "Sequel movie revenue prediction model based on sentiment analysis." *Data Technologies and Applications* 54, no. 5 (2020): 665–683.
- **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Azuraliza Abu Bakar, Mohd Ridzwan Yaakub, and Mohammad Darwich. "Beyond sentiment classification: A novel approach for utilizing social media data for business intelligence." *International Journal of Advanced Computer Science and Applications* 11, no. 3 (2020).
- Ansari Abdollah, **Ibrahim Said Ahmad**, Azuraliza Abu Bakar, and Mohd Ridzwan Yaakub. "A hybrid metaheuristic method in training artificial neural network for bankruptcy prediction." *IEEE Access* 8 (2020): 176640–176650.

Presentations

Contributed Presentations

- **Ahmad, I. S.** January 2021. How to prepare for a proposal defense. A postgraduate seminar series presented at the Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, Bayero University Kano.
- **Ahmad, I. S.** January 2021. Significant Tips for a new researcher. A webinar presented virtually for new postgraduate students.
- **Ahmad, I. S.**, Bakar, A. A., & Yaakub, M. R. 2018. Predicting Movie Success from Trailer Reviews. In Proceeding of 1st International Postgraduate Conference. Nilai, Malaysia.
- **Ahmad, I. S.** January 2017. Sentiment Analysis: Algorithms and Applications. A paper presented at a seminar organized by Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, Bayero University Kano.
- **Ahmad, I. S.** November 2015. Engaging Children with ADHD using Mobile Based Games. A paper presented at a seminar organized by Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, Bayero University Kano.

Outreach & Professional Development

Community Engagement

2026	Co-Organizer , Data, Culture, and Community: An Interactive Exhibition of the AfricaNLP Playbook and Annotation Tool – Deep Learning Indaba 2026, Lagos, Nigeria
2026	Organizer , SemEval 2026 Task 9: Detecting Multilingual, Multicultural and Multievent Online Polarization (POLAR)
2024	Organizer , SemEval 2025 Task 11: Bridging the Gap in Text-Based Emotion Detection
2024	Organizer , International Conference on Spoken Language Translation (IWSLT) low-resource track shared task
2023	Organizer , SemEval-2023 Task 12: Sentiment Analysis for African Languages (AfriSenti-SemEval)

Professional Memberships

1. **Member:** Internet Society (ISOC) 2020 – Date
2. **Member:** World Institute for Nuclear Security (WINS) 2020 – Date

Peer Review

I served as reviewer for prominent journals including Information Processing & Management (Elsevier), Neural Computing and Applications (Springer Nature), SN Computer Science (Springer Nature) and IEEE Access. I also contributed to major confer-

ences such as ACL and LREC. I am selected for the Program Committee of the 31st International Conference on Computational Linguistics (2025).